"We took the initial art from the Art Department, as well as the research they had done on how they'd dress the Atlanta locations to double as Africa, and combined it with our own research," Visual Effects Producer Jen Underdahl says. "It was pretty amazing—when we got to Puerto Rico on one of our earlier scouts, we were standing on top of the building Falcon stands on at the film's opening, and we were floored at how much it mirrored the research we had done on Lagos."

Due to its striking similarities, the Visual Effects team decided to use the location for background replacements. "We shot a plate unit down in Puerto Rico with drones and helicopters and camera trucks," Dan Deleeuw says. "We had numerous people scanning and photographing tons and tons of buildings with a lot of tactile texture and character, and used those in post-production to replace the backgrounds outside the Civic Center in Atlanta. All the people you see in the cars on the streets were practical in Atlanta, but the buildings behind them are all the plates we shot down in Puerto Rico."